

Grade 9

English & Language Skills

Advanced Spoken English • Grammar • Literature •
Vocabulary • Debate • Writing

Your Skill-Building Workbook

□ Think

- Analyse ideas, explain evidence, connect themes.

● Speak

- Build fluency, articulation, discussion and interview confidence.

✦ Create

- Write, transform, debate, present and express your own ideas.

★ How to use this workbook

- Grade 9-appropriate exam readiness with real-world communication practice.
- Spacious activities designed for writing, speaking, reflection and peer work.
- Use the workbook alongside your school / board textbook sequence.

✦ About This Curriculum

From board-exam accuracy
to real communication
confidence

□ Grammar

- Precise, exam-oriented grammar: connectors, modals, reported speech, editing, omission and transformation.

□ Prose & Poetry

- Critical appreciation, drama/prose analysis, précis, unseen passages, poetic devices and writer's craft.

□ Vocabulary

- Advanced contextual vocabulary, idioms, one-word substitution, register and editorial/academic usage.

□ Spoken English

- Fluency, articulation, interviews, group discussion, formal presentations and oral-exam readiness.

🗨️ Debate & Speech Writing

- Formal debate, rebuttal, evidence, exam-format speech writing, persuasive techniques and delivery.

□ Learning Goals — Grade 9

- Use connectors, modals & all forms of reported speech accurately.
- Write a précis and analyse an unseen passage independently.
- Use advanced vocabulary and idioms appropriately in writing & speech.
- Deliver a 2-3 minute structured speech confidently.
- Take part in a formal debate with a clear stance and evidence.

Term-wise Curriculum Map

Grade-specific progression across the year

Strand	TERM 1	TERM 2
Grammar	Modal Auxiliaries, Connectors, Tenses review	Direct-Indirect Speech, Sentence transformation
Prose & Poetry	Drama extract (Act-wise study) + 2 poems	Prose extracts + précis writing practice
Vocabulary	Synonyms/Antonyms (advanced), Idioms	One-word substitution, Words often confused
Spoken English	Fluency & articulation drills, structured conversation, listening for opinion	Formal presentations, interview skills, group discussion
Debate & Speech	Speech-writing format, opinion building, JAM/extempore	Formal debate (for/against), debate-writing format, rebuttal practice

Note: Re-order to match your school's board syllabus and textbook sequence.

Written

- Integrated grammar & editing tests
- Précis, unseen passage & critical appreciation
- Speech/Debate writing (exam format)

Oral

- Formal debate performance
- Presentation with visual aid
- Interview/viva-style Q&A;

Listening

- Listen & critically respond
- Note arguments in a talk/debate
- Summarise a discussion accurately

Portfolio

- Vocabulary & idiom journal
- Speech/debate script file
- Self & peer feedback forms

Grammar Syllabus

Exam-precision applied to
real communication

◆ GRADE 9

- Modal Auxiliaries — can/could, may/might, must/shall
- Connectors — because, although, so that, in spite of
- Tenses — full review including perfect & perfect continuous
- Direct-Indirect Speech — statements, questions, commands
- Active-Passive Voice — all tenses and with modals
- Clauses — noun, adjective, adverb (applied use)
- Sentence transformation — simple/compound/complex

□ How grammar is taught

- Oral drill before written application
- Weekly editing/transformation exercise in exam format
- Grammar accuracy checked inside speech and debate scripts
- Timed practice papers introduced closer to assessments

□ Student mindset

- Check the structure, then check the meaning.
- Explain why an answer works, not only what the answer is.
- Re-read transformed sentences for accuracy and register.

□ Prose & Poetry

Critical appreciation —
reading like an examiner and
a reader

□ GRADE 9 — Reading Focus

- A classic drama, studied Act-wise
- Prose extracts on social/moral themes
- A reflective poem & a narrative poem
- Précis writing practice on formal passages

□ Critical Appreciation

- Theme, tone, central message & context
- Character analysis and author's intent
- Comparing perspectives across texts

□ Literary Devices

- Simile, metaphor, irony, imagery
- Rhyme scheme, rhythm & poetic structure
- Explain the effect of a device, not just naming it

□ Précis & Summary

- Reduce a passage to one-third length
- Retain the main idea and remove detail
- Suggest an appropriate title

Response Writing

- Critical response/opinion on the text
- Character's monologue or diary entry
- Connect the text's theme to modern life

Vocabulary Building

Precision, register and advanced word command

GRADE 9 FOCUS

- Synonyms/Antonyms — advanced, in context
- Idioms & phrasal verbs in formal and casual use
- One-word substitution — exam-level
- Words often confused (affect/effect, principal/principle)

Monthly Theme Word Banks (sample)

Theme	Sample Grade 9 words
Debate & Argument	assert, oppose, justify, agree
Society & Issues	inequality, awareness, reform, impact
Ambition & Character	resilient, disciplined, sincere, humble
Current Affairs	issue, decision, controversy, initiative

Weekly Vocabulary Routine

- Monday: 8–10 new words introduced with usage in a sentence and register note
- Wednesday: Use 4 words in a 1-minute spoken argument on a given topic
- Friday: Idiom/one-word substitution quiz + vocabulary journal review

Spoken English

Fluency for exams,
interviews and real life

Listening & Critical Response

- Listen to a talk/debate and note arguments
- Summarise and give a personal opinion
- Follow and respond to formal instructions

Articulation & Fluency

- Clear articulation and pacing
- Reducing fillers, building natural pauses
- Stress and intonation for emphasis

Discussion & Interview Skills

- Structured group discussion technique
- Answering unexpected questions calmly
- Formal introductions & professional tone

Presentation Skills

- Presentations with slides/visual aids
- Signposting ("firstly", "in conclusion")
- Handling audience questions confidently

Oral Exam Readiness

- Reading aloud with correct expression
- Answering viva-style questions on a text
- Structured, confident spoken answers

Real-life English

- Mock interviews for higher studies/jobs
- Formal phone & email conversations
- Giving a vote of thanks / formal announcement

Sample Weekly Spoken English Plan

Day	Activity	Skill Focus
Mon	Listen to a talk/debate clip + note key arguments	Critical Listening
Tue	Articulation drill + fluency read-aloud	Pronunciation & Fluency
Wed	Structured group discussion on a current topic	Discussion Skills
Thu	Formal presentation / mock interview practice	Presentation & Interview Skills
Fri	JAM / extempore + vocabulary & grammar recap	Confidence & Fluency

⚖️ Debate & Speech Writing

Formal structure, persuasion and confident delivery

□ Formal Debate

- Motion, For/Against, timed speeches
- Opening → arguments → rebuttal → conclusion
- Using facts, statistics & logical reasoning

□ Speech Writing (exam format)

- Title, respectful salutation/greeting
- Engaging opening, 3 well-developed points
- Strong closing + vote of thanks

□ Extempore & JAM

- 1-minute preparation, then speak fluently
- Organising thoughts under time pressure
- Confident body language and voice control

□ Persuasive Techniques

- Rhetorical questions & repetition
- Appeals to logic, emotion and credibility
- Anticipating and countering objections

Exam-format Speech / Debate Writing Structure

□ Six-step structure

- 1. Title — a short, relevant heading
- 2. Salutation — respectful greeting
- 3. Opening — a hook: question, quote, or fact
- 4. Body — 2-3 developed arguments/points with examples
- 5. Closing — summary / call to action
- 6. Thanking note — thank the audience

□ Sample Debate & Speech Topics

- Social media does more harm than good — Discuss.
- Examinations are not a true measure of a student's ability.
- Should artificial intelligence replace human jobs?
- The importance of protecting the environment for future generations.
- Should voting be made compulsory for all adult citizens?

Practice Worksheet 1 — Grammar (Grade 9)

Name: _____

Date: _____

Exam-focused practice • Use precise grammar in context

♦ A. Modal Auxiliaries

- Fill in the blanks with a suitable modal (can, must, should, may).
- 1. You _____ finish your homework before you watch TV.
- 2. _____ I borrow your pen for a moment?
- 3. Students _____ respect their teachers.

□ B. Connectors

- Join the sentences using the connector given in brackets.
- 1. He was tired. He continued working. (although)
- 2. She saved money. She could buy a new phone. (so that)

□ C. Direct → Indirect Speech

- Rewrite each sentence in reported speech.
- 1. She said, "What a beautiful painting this is!"
- 2. The officer said, "Stand in a queue, please."
- 3. He asked, "Have you completed the project?"

Write your answers clearly. Use complete sentences where required.

Practice Worksheet 2 — Grammar (Grade 9)

Name: _____

Date: _____

Transformation • Editing • Integrated grammar

□ Integrated Practice

- 1. Rewrite: She said, "I have finished the work." → _____
- 2. Change to passive: They must complete the form today. → _____
- 3. Combine using "although": He was tired. He continued working. → _____
- 4. Transform into a complex sentence: He worked hard and succeeded. → _____

Explain one correction or transformation in a short note:

Practice Worksheet 3 — Vocabulary (Grade 9)

Name: _____

Date: _____

Context • Register • Idioms • One-word substitution

□ A. Choose the closest meaning

- 1. candid = (honest / rude / careless)
- 2. mitigate = (increase / reduce / ignore)
- 3. tenacious = (lazy / determined / shy)

□ B. Use each expression in your own sentence

- 1. "Once in a blue moon" —
- 2. "Hit the nail on the head" —

□ C. One-word substitution

- 1. A person who loves and collects books —
- 2. A remedy for all diseases/problems —
- 3. One who is present everywhere at the same time —

Practice Worksheet 4 — Critical Appreciation

Name: _____

Date: _____

Unseen passage • Poem • Précis / inference practice

□ Read the unseen passage

• Progress, we are told, is measured in speed — faster trains, faster internet, faster decisions. Yet the wisest people in history often achieved their greatest work through patience, not haste. The scientist who spends a decade on a single question, the writer who rewrites a page ten times, the craftsman who refuses to rush a single joint — all remind us that some of the most valuable things cannot be hurried. Perhaps true progress lies not in doing things faster, but in doing the right things well.

1. According to the passage, how is progress usually measured?

2. Give one example the author uses to show the value of patience.

3. What is the author's main message? (in your own words)

4. Suggest a suitable title for this passage.

□ Poetry Lens

- "The city sleeps beneath a quilt of light, / Its towers whispering to the waking dawn; / Time, that silent sculptor, carves the night..."
- 5. Identify and explain one figure of speech.
- 6. What does "Time, that silent sculptor" suggest?

Practice Worksheet 5 — Speech Writing

Name: _____

Date: _____

Exam-format practice with a guided template

☐ Write a speech on: “The Importance of Protecting the Environment”

- Use the structure below to plan before writing your final speech.

Title:	_____
Salutation:	_____
Opening hook:	_____
Point 1 + example:	_____
Point 2 + example:	_____
Point 3 + example:	_____
Closing statement:	_____
Thanking note:	_____

Final speech writing space

Practice Worksheet 6 — Debate Writing & Extempore

Name: _____

Date: _____

Argument building • Rebuttal practice • JAM topics

A. Build Your Debate

- Motion: “Examinations are not a true measure of a student’s ability.”
- Choose your side: ☐ For ☐ Against
- Argument 1:
- Supporting example/evidence:
- Argument 2:
- Supporting example/evidence:
- Anticipated objection from the other side:
- Your rebuttal:

B. Extempore & JAM Topics

- “Is technology making us less social?”
- “The value of failure in personal growth”
- “Should students have a say in how schools are run?”

Practice Worksheet 7 — Spoken English & Interview Skills

Name: _____

Date: _____

Fluency cards • Group discussion • Mock interview

1. Fluency Cards — pick any 2 and speak for 1-2 minutes each

- A challenge I overcame and what I learned from it.
- My view on whether marks truly reflect a student's ability.
- A leader (real or fictional) I admire and why.
- One change I would bring to my school if I could.

2. Group Discussion Prompt (4-5 students)

- Topic: "Should students be allowed to choose their own subjects from Grade 9 onwards?"
- Each speaker should: (a) state a clear position, (b) support it with a reason/example, (c) respond respectfully to at least one other speaker's point.

3. Mock Interview — answer aloud with a partner

- "Tell me about yourself in under a minute."
- "What is one strength and one area you are working to improve?"
- "Why do you think this subject/activity matters to you?"

Teacher's Answer Key

For Worksheets 1–4 only —
remove this page before
giving worksheets to
students

✓ **Worksheet 1 — Grammar (Grade 9)**

- A. 1. must/should 2. May 3. should
- B. 1. Although he was tired, he continued working. 2. She saved money so that she could buy a new phone.
- C. 1. She exclaimed that it was a beautiful painting. 2. The officer requested them to stand in a queue. 3. He asked if/whether she had completed the project.

✓ **Worksheet 2 — Integrated Grammar**

- Answers depend on the transformations used; accept grammatically correct equivalent forms that preserve meaning.

✓ **Worksheet 3 — Vocabulary**

- A. 1. honest 2. reduce 3. determined
- B. Sample sentences vary — check meaning and context.
- C. Bibliophile, Panacea, Omnipresent.

✓ **Worksheet 4 — Critical Appreciation**

- 1. In terms of speed. 2. The scientist who spends a decade on one question, or the writer who rewrites a page many times. 3. True progress means doing the right things well, not simply doing things faster. 4. Sample: “The True Meaning of Progress”. 5. Metaphor/personification. 6. Time quietly and gradually shapes and changes everything.

Curriculum & worksheets prepared for classroom use — adapt freely to match your board syllabus and students’ pace.